THE COMMS BOARD ROOM

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TECH & COMMS · SPEAKER CONCEPT NOTE · TOPIC 01

Communications: School vs Reality

Where Communications Meet Technology

Gabriel Ntoka SPEAKER

DATE	Thursday, 26 November 2026
VENUE	Legacy Hall, Crawford University
YOUR ROLE	Speaker
YOUR SESSION	Communications: School vs Reality
LENGTH	20 minutes; questions from students come in the open Q&A at the end
AUDIENCE	Mass Communication students (all levels), with lecturers and alumni
FORMAT	Three 20-minute talks, a panel, then an open Q&A in the hall
PARTNERS	Department of Mass Communication, Crawford University, and the Crawford University Alumni Association

01 About Tech & Comms

Tech & Comms is an initiative of The Comms Boardroom (TCBR) to close the gap between what students are taught about communications and what the profession looks like on the ground. It is not a lecture series. It is a set of honest conversations, led by people currently doing the work, built around three things every Mass Communication student deserves to hear before they graduate: communications in the real world, media intelligence and proving value, and building a personal brand.

02 Why this session matters

Textbooks tend to describe communications as one fixed thing. It isn't. Brand and business communications looks completely different depending on the organisation, the industry and, especially, the country you practise in.

What communications looks like in Nigeria is not always what the books describe, and that difference matters. This session is the honest, unfiltered picture of the work, and where technology is starting to change it. It opens the day and sets the tone for everything after it.

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03 What we would love you to cover

- How communications actually works inside an organisation: who you report to, who you depend on, and how decisions really get made.
- How the job changes by sector, for example banking, FMCG, tech, government, NGOs and agencies.
- The Nigerian realities: stakeholder management, media relations culture, speed, and handling a crisis in public.
- Where technology is already changing the day-to-day work: tools, data, speed of response and the skills that now matter.
- Two or three "school says / reality says" contrasts from your own experience.

04 Suggested flow

1	**Open**	A moment from your career when the textbook answer was not enough.
2	**The real job**	What a normal week in communications looks like, and who you work with.
3	**School vs reality**	Two or three contrasts the students will remember.
4	**Where tech fits**	What has changed in the work in the last few years.
5	**Close**	What students should start doing now, while still in school.

A suggestion only. Shape it around your own stories.

05 What students should leave with

> - Communications is shaped by the organisation, the industry and the country.
> - The skills employers want now go beyond theory: judgement, speed and comfort with tools.
> - Students can start building real experience before they graduate.

06 Questions students may ask you

- What did you have to unlearn after school?
- How do I get practical experience while I'm still a student?
- Which sector is best to start a communications career in?
- How do you handle a crisis when the facts are still unclear?

07 Tone and approach

- Speak from your own work. Real examples, real numbers where you can share them, and real mistakes land better than definitions.
- Keep it Nigerian. Show how the work looks here, not only how the textbooks describe it.
- Talk with the students, not at them. Short stories, plain language, and room for questions.
- Leave them with something to do this week, not only something to think about.

08 What we need from you

- A short bio (60–80 words) and a clear headshot, for the programme and our social posts.
- Slides are optional. If you use them, please send them a day before so we can load them on the hall system.
- Your preferred social handles, so we can tag you when we share highlights.
- Any equipment you need (for example, internet access for a live demo).

Thank you for giving your time to the next generation of communicators.

Samuel Ogundeji
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